

Use these examples to help build your narrative. Adapt them — make them your own.

Fronted Adverbials		
Place	Time	Manner
At the far end of the alley,	As the night grew darker,	Trembling with every step,
Deep in the shadows,	After what felt like hours,	Moving as quietly as he could,
In the yellow glow of the lamp,	In that very moment,	With his claws out and ears flat,
Beneath the cold brickwork,	Before he could take a breath,	Without making a single sound,
Beyond the edge of the light,	Just as dawn began to break,	Pressing close against the wall,

Similes
• The car's headlights blazed like two trapped suns. • The alleyway was as cold and still as the inside of a tomb. • The dog's growl rumbled like distant thunder beneath the street. • The shadows moved like something alive and hungry. • The noise hit him like a wave crashing against rock. • The city roared like a creature that had never once slept. • The silence fell like the held breath of the whole world.

Alliteration
• damp, dark doorways • shadows slipped and slid • cold, cracked cobblestones • prowling, patient, perfectly still • growling, glittering, glaring eyes • strange, shadowy, silent streets • screeching, scattering, scrambling into the dark • bold and brave and bristling with anger

Hyperbole
• His heart was beating hard enough to wake the whole city. • The dog's growl was loud enough to shake the stones from the wall. • He had never been so afraid in all his nine lives. • The city seemed to stretch on for a thousand miles. • The noise was so vast it filled every corner of the night.

Power of Three
• The city was cold, loud and completely alive. • He could smell rust, damp stone and something he had no name for. • The streetlights flickered, buzzed and blinked out one by one. • The gang was fast, silent and absolutely everywhere. • He was afraid. He was alone. He was far from home. • She crouched. She listened. She did not move. • Varjak's claws were out. His teeth were bared. He was ready. • The alley was dark. It was silent. It smelled of danger.

Direct Speech — structures and speech verbs	
Different ways to place the reporting clause	Speech verbs
Reporting clause AFTER the speech: <i>"You lost?" she said. / "Run," yelled Holly.</i>	Quiet / calm whispered murmured breathed replied said
Action BEFORE the speech: <i>Varjak swallowed. "I need your help," he stammered.</i>	Tense / urgent stammered faltered urged rasped hissed
Reporting clause SPLITS the speech: <i>"That," said Tam quietly, "is a dog."</i>	Angry / harsh growled snarled snapped spat barked
No reporting clause (speaker is clear): <i>"Run!"</i>	Loud / alarmed yelled called cried shouted warned
Reporting clause BEFORE the speech: <i>Holly tilted her head and said, "Dogs are different."</i>	

Powerful Verbs							
Moving through the city		Sounds and voices		Showing fear or shock		Fighting and defending	
crept	skulked	growled	scraped	swallowed	faltered	swiped	sprang
prowled	edged	screeched	clattered	shuddered	trembled	lunged	blocked
slunk	bolted	hissed	echoed	bristled	braced	dodged	spun
darted	lurched	yowled	stammered	flinched	recoiled	leaped	struck
pressed	froze	rumbled	snarled	tensed	clung	launched	scattered
scrambled	vanished	thundered	rasped	hesitated	steadied	twisted	retreated